

BibInVs MN 49

Ephesians

*Bible Translation:
Interverse MSG/NIV - 49*

God

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Interversed Message/NIV Bible

Ephesians

Ephesians 1

MSG

NIV

- 1 I, Paul, am under God's plan as an apostle, a special agent of Christ Jesus, writing to you faithful Christians in Ephesus.
- 1 Paul, an apostle of Christ Jesus by the will of God, To the saints in Ephesus, the faithful in Christ Jesus:
- 2 I greet you with the grace and peace poured into our lives by God our Father and our Master, Jesus Christ.
- 2 Grace and peace to you from God our Father and the Lord Jesus Christ.
- 3 How blessed is God! And what a blessing he is! He's the Father of our Master, Jesus Christ, and takes us to the high places of blessing in him.
- 3 Praise be to the God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, who has blessed us in the heavenly realms with every spiritual blessing in Christ.
- 4 Long before he laid down earth's foundations, he had us in mind, had settled on us as the focus of his love, to be made whole and holy by his love.
- 4 For he chose us in him before the creation of the world to be holy and blameless in his sight. In love
- 5 Long, long ago he decided to adopt us into his family through Jesus Christ. (What pleasure he took in planning this!)
- 5 he predestined us to be adopted as his sons through Jesus Christ, in accordance with his pleasure and will--
- 6 He wanted us to enter into the celebration of his lavish gift-giving by the hand of his beloved Son.
- 6 to the praise of his glorious grace, which he has freely given us in the One he loves.
- 7 Because of the sacrifice of the Messiah, his blood poured out on the altar of the Cross, we're a free people--free of penalties and punishments

chalked up by all our misdeeds. And not just barely free, either.
Abundantly free!

- 7 In him we have redemption through his blood, the forgiveness of sins, in accordance with the riches of God's grace
- 8 He thought of everything, provided for everything we could possibly need,
- 8 that he lavished on us with all wisdom and understanding.
- 9 letting us in on the plans he took such delight in making. He set it all out before us in Christ,
- 9 And he made known to us the mystery of his will according to his good pleasure, which he purposed in Christ,
- 10 a long-range plan in which everything would be brought together and summed up in him, everything in deepest heaven, everything on planet earth.
- 10 to be put into effect when the times will have reached their fulfillment--to bring all things in heaven and on earth together under one head, even Christ.
- 11 It's in Christ that we find out who we are and what we are living for. Long before we first heard of Christ and got our hopes up, he had his eye on us, had designs on us for glorious living,
- 11 In him we were also chosen, having been predestined according to the plan of him who works out everything in conformity with the purpose of his will,
- 12 part of the overall purpose he is working out in everything and everyone.
- 12 in order that we, who were the first to hope in Christ, might be for the praise of his glory.
- 13 It's in Christ that you, once you heard the truth and believed it (this Message of your salvation), found yourselves home free--signed, sealed, and delivered by the Holy Spirit.
- 13 And you also were included in Christ when you heard the word of truth, the gospel of your salvation. Having believed, you were marked in him with a seal, the promised Holy Spirit,
- 14 This signet from God is the first installment on what's coming, a reminder that we'll get everything God has planned for us, a praising and glorious life.

14 who is a deposit guaranteeing our inheritance until the redemption of those who are God's possession--to the praise of his glory.

15 That's why, when I heard of the solid trust you have in the Master Jesus and your outpouring of love to all the Christians,

15 For this reason, ever since I heard about your faith in the Lord Jesus and your love for all the saints,

16 I couldn't stop thanking God for you--every time I prayed, I'd think of you and give thanks.

16 I have not stopped giving thanks for you, remembering you in my prayers.

17 But I do more than thank. I ask--ask the God of our Master, Jesus Christ, the God of glory--to make you intelligent and discerning in knowing him personally,

17 I keep asking that the God of our Lord Jesus Christ, the glorious Father, may give you the Spirit of wisdom and revelation, so that you may know him better.

18 your eyes focused and clear, so that you can see exactly what it is he is calling you to do, grasp the immensity of this glorious way of life he has for Christians,

18 I pray also that the eyes of your heart may be enlightened in order that you may know the hope to which he has called you, the riches of his glorious inheritance in the saints,

19 oh, the utter extravagance of his work in us who trust him--endless energy, boundless strength!

19 and his incomparably great power for us who believe. That power is like the working of his mighty strength,

20 All this energy issues from Christ: God raised him from death and set him on a throne in deep heaven,

20 which he exerted in Christ when he raised him from the dead and seated him at his right hand in the heavenly realms,

21 in charge of running the universe, everything from galaxies to governments, no name and no power exempt from his rule. And not just for the time being, but forever.

21 far above all rule and authority, power and dominion, and every title that can be given, not only in the present age but also in the one to come.

- 22 He is in charge of it all, has the final word on everything. At the center of all this, Christ rules the church.
- 22 And God placed all things under his feet and appointed him to be head over everything for the church,
- 23 The church, you see, is not peripheral to the world; the world is peripheral to the church. The church is Christ's body, in which he speaks and acts, by which he fills everything with his presence.
- 23 which is his body, the fullness of him who fills everything in every way.

Ephesians 2

MSG

NIV

- 1 It wasn't so long ago that you were mired in that old stagnant life of sin.
- 1 As for you, you were dead in your transgressions and sins,
- 2 You let the world, which doesn't know the first thing about living, tell you how to live. You filled your lungs with polluted unbelief, and then exhaled disobedience.
- 2 in which you used to live when you followed the ways of this world and of the ruler of the kingdom of the air, the spirit who is now at work in those who are disobedient.
- 3 We all did it, all of us doing what we felt like doing, when we felt like doing it, all of us in the same boat. It's a wonder God didn't lose his temper and do away with the whole lot of us.
- 3 All of us also lived among them at one time, gratifying the cravings of our sinful nature and following its desires and thoughts. Like the rest, we were by nature objects of wrath.
- 4 Instead, immense in mercy and with an incredible love,
- 4 But because of his great love for us, God, who is rich in mercy,
- 5 he embraced us. He took our sin-dead lives and made us alive in Christ. He did all this on his own, with no help from us!
- 5 made us alive with Christ even when we were dead in transgressions--it is by grace you have been saved.
- 6 Then he picked us up and set us down in highest heaven in company with Jesus, our Messiah.

- 6 And God raised us up with Christ and seated us with him in the heavenly realms in Christ Jesus,
- 7 Now God has us where he wants us, with all the time in this world and the next to shower grace and kindness upon us in Christ Jesus.
- 7 in order that in the coming ages he might show the incomparable riches of his grace, expressed in his kindness to us in Christ Jesus.
- 8 Saving is all his idea, and all his work. All we do is trust him enough to let him do it. It's God's gift from start to finish!
- 8 For it is by grace you have been saved, through faith--and this not from yourselves, it is the gift of God--
- 9 We don't play the major role. If we did, we'd probably go around bragging that we'd done the whole thing!
- 9 not by works, so that no one can boast.
- 10 No, we neither make nor save ourselves. God does both the making and saving. He creates each of us by Christ Jesus to join him in the work he does, the good work he has gotten ready for us to do, work we had better be doing.
- 10 For we are God's workmanship, created in Christ Jesus to do good works, which God prepared in advance for us to do.
- 11 But don't take any of this for granted. It was only yesterday that you outsiders to God's ways
- 11 Therefore, remember that formerly you who are Gentiles by birth and called "uncircumcised" by those who call themselves "the circumcision" (that done in the body by the hands of men)--
- 12 had no idea of any of this, didn't know the first thing about the way God works, hadn't the faintest idea of Christ. You knew nothing of that rich history of God's covenants and promises in Israel, hadn't a clue about what God was doing in the world at large.
- 12 remember that at that time you were separate from Christ, excluded from citizenship in Israel and foreigners to the covenants of the promise, without hope and without God in the world.
- 13 Now because of Christ--dying that death, shedding that blood--you who were once out of it altogether are in on everything.
- 13 But now in Christ Jesus you who once were far away have been brought near through the blood of Christ.

- 14 The Messiah has made things up between us so that we're now together on this, both non-Jewish outsiders and Jewish insiders. He tore down the wall we used to keep each other at a distance.
- 14 For he himself is our peace, who has made the two one and has destroyed the barrier, the dividing wall of hostility,
- 15 He repealed the law code that had become so clogged with fine print and footnotes that it hindered more than it helped. Then he started over. Instead of continuing with two groups of people separated by centuries of animosity and suspicion, he created a new kind of human being, a fresh start for everybody.
- 15 by abolishing in his flesh the law with its commandments and regulations. His purpose was to create in himself one new man out of the two, thus making peace,
- 16 Christ brought us together through his death on the Cross. The Cross got us to embrace, and that was the end of the hostility.
- 16 and in this one body to reconcile both of them to God through the cross, by which he put to death their hostility.
- 17 Christ came and preached peace to you outsiders and peace to us insiders.
- 17 He came and preached peace to you who were far away and peace to those who were near.
- 18 He treated us as equals, and so made us equals. Through him we both share the same Spirit and have equal access to the Father.
- 18 For through him we both have access to the Father by one Spirit.
- 19 That's plain enough, isn't it? You're no longer wandering exiles. This kingdom of faith is now your home country. You're no longer strangers or outsiders. You belong here, with as much right to the name Christian as anyone. God is building a home. He's using us all--irrespective of how we got here--in what he is building.
- 19 Consequently, you are no longer foreigners and aliens, but fellow citizens with God's people and members of God's household,
- 20 He used the apostles and prophets for the foundation. Now he's using you, fitting you in brick by brick, stone by stone, with Christ Jesus as the cornerstone
- 20 built on the foundation of the apostles and prophets, with Christ Jesus himself as the chief cornerstone.

- 21 that holds all the parts together. We see it taking shape day after day--a holy temple built by God,
- 21 In him the whole building is joined together and rises to become a holy temple in the Lord.
- 22 all of us built into it, a temple in which God is quite at home.
- 22 And in him you too are being built together to become a dwelling in which God lives by his Spirit.

Ephesians 3

MSG

NIV

- 1 This is why I, Paul, am in jail for Christ, having taken up the cause of you outsiders, so-called.
- 1 For this reason I, Paul, the prisoner of Christ Jesus for the sake of you Gentiles--
- 2 I take it that you're familiar with the part I was given in God's plan for including everybody.
- 2 Surely you have heard about the administration of God's grace that was given to me for you,
- 3 I got the inside story on this from God himself, as I just wrote you in brief.
- 3 that is, the mystery made known to me by revelation, as I have already written briefly.
- 4 As you read over what I have written to you, you'll be able to see for yourselves into the mystery of Christ.
- 4 In reading this, then, you will be able to understand my insight into the mystery of Christ,
- 5 None of our ancestors understood this. Only in our time has it been made clear by God's Spirit through his holy apostles and prophets of this new order.
- 5 which was not made known to men in other generations as it has now been revealed by the Spirit to God's holy apostles and prophets.
- 6 The mystery is that people who have never heard of God and those who have heard of him all their lives (what I've been calling outsiders and insiders) stand on the same ground before God. They get the same offer,

same help, same promises in Christ Jesus. The Message is accessible and welcoming to everyone, across the board.

- 6 This mystery is that through the gospel the Gentiles are heirs together with Israel, members together of one body, and sharers together in the promise in Christ Jesus.
- 7 This is my life work: helping people understand and respond to this Message. It came as a sheer gift to me, a real surprise, God handling all the details.
- 7 I became a servant of this gospel by the gift of God's grace given me through the working of his power.
- 8 When it came to presenting the Message to people who had no background in God's way, I was the least qualified of any of the available Christians. God saw to it that I was equipped, but you can be sure that it had nothing to do with my natural abilities. And so here I am, preaching and writing about things that are way over my head, the inexhaustible riches and generosity of Christ.
- 8 Although I am less than the least of all God's people, this grace was given me: to preach to the Gentiles the unsearchable riches of Christ,
- 9 My task is to bring out in the open and make plain what God, who created all this in the first place, has been doing in secret and behind the scenes all along.
- 9 and to make plain to everyone the administration of this mystery, which for ages past was kept hidden in God, who created all things.
- 10 Through Christians like yourselves gathered in churches, this extraordinary plan of God is becoming known and talked about even among the angels!
- 10 His intent was that now, through the church, the manifold wisdom of God should be made known to the rulers and authorities in the heavenly realms,
- 11 All this is proceeding along lines planned all along by God and then executed in Christ Jesus.
- 11 according to his eternal purpose which he accomplished in Christ Jesus our Lord.
- 12 When we trust in him, we're free to say whatever needs to be said, bold to go wherever we need to go.

12 In him and through faith in him we may approach God with freedom and confidence.

13 So don't let my present trouble on your behalf get you down. Be proud!

13 I ask you, therefore, not to be discouraged because of my sufferings for you, which are your glory.

14 My response is to get down on my knees before the Father,

14 For this reason I kneel before the Father,

15 this magnificent Father who parcels out all heaven and earth.

15 from whom his whole family in heaven and on earth derives its name.

16 I ask him to strengthen you by his Spirit--not a brute strength but a glorious inner strength--

16 I pray that out of his glorious riches he may strengthen you with power through his Spirit in your inner being,

17 that Christ will live in you as you open the door and invite him in. And I ask him that with both feet planted firmly on love,

17 so that Christ may dwell in your hearts through faith. And I pray that you, being rooted and established in love,

18 you'll be able to take in with all Christians the extravagant dimensions of Christ's love. Reach out and experience the breadth! Test its length! Plumb the depths! Rise to the heights!

18 may have power, together with all the saints, to grasp how wide and long and high and deep is the love of Christ,

19 Live full lives, full in the fullness of God.

19 and to know this love that surpasses knowledge--that you may be filled to the measure of all the fullness of God.

20 God can do anything, you know--far more than you could ever imagine or guess or request in your wildest dreams! He does it not by pushing us around but by working within us, his Spirit deeply and gently within us.

20 Now to him who is able to do immeasurably more than all we ask or imagine, according to his power that is at work within us,

21 Glory to God in the church! Glory to God in the Messiah, in Jesus! Glory down all the generations! Glory through all millennia! Oh, yes!

21 to him be glory in the church and in Christ Jesus throughout all generations, for ever and ever! Amen.

Ephesians 4

MSG

NIV

- 1 In light of all this, here's what I want you to do. While I'm locked up here, a prisoner for the Master, I want you to get out there and walk--better yet, run!--on the road God called you to travel. I don't want any of you sitting around on your hands. I don't want anyone strolling off, down some path that goes nowhere.
- 1 As a prisoner for the Lord, then, I urge you to live a life worthy of the calling you have received.
- 2 And mark that you do this with humility and discipline--not in fits and starts, but steadily, pouring yourselves out for each other in acts of love,
- 2 Be completely humble and gentle; be patient, bearing with one another in love.
- 3 alert at noticing differences and quick at mending fences.
- 3 Make every effort to keep the unity of the Spirit through the bond of peace.
- 4 You were all called to travel on the same road and in the same direction, so stay together, both outwardly and inwardly.
- 4 There is one body and one Spirit-- just as you were called to one hope when you were called--
- 5 You have one Master, one faith, one baptism,
- 5 one Lord, one faith, one baptism;
- 6 one God and Father of all, who rules over all, works through all, and is present in all. Everything you are and think and do is permeated with Oneness.
- 6 one God and Father of all, who is over all and through all and in all.
- 7 But that doesn't mean you should all look and speak and act the same. Out of the generosity of Christ, each of us is given his own gift.
- 7 But to each one of us grace has been given as Christ apportioned it.
- 8 The text for this is, He climbed the high mountain, He captured the enemy and seized the booty, He handed it all out in gifts to the people.
- 8 This is why it says: "When he ascended on high, he led captives in his train and gave gifts to men."

- 9 It's true, is it not, that the One who climbed up also climbed down, down to the valley of earth?
- 9 (What does "he ascended" mean except that he also descended to the lower, earthly regions?
- 10 And the One who climbed down is the One who climbed back up, up to highest heaven. He handed out gifts above and below, filled heaven with his gifts,
- 10 He who descended is the very one who ascended higher than all the heavens, in order to fill the whole universe.)
- 11 filled earth with his gifts. He handed out gifts of apostle, prophet, evangelist, and pastor-teacher
- 11 It was he who gave some to be apostles, some to be prophets, some to be evangelists, and some to be pastors and teachers,
- 12 to train Christians in skilled servant work, working within Christ's body, the church,
- 12 to prepare God's people for works of service, so that the body of Christ may be built up
- 13 until we're all moving rhythmically and easily with each other, efficient and graceful in response to God's Son, fully mature adults, fully developed within and without, fully alive like Christ.
- 13 until we all reach unity in the faith and in the knowledge of the Son of God and become mature, attaining to the whole measure of the fullness of Christ.
- 14 No prolonged infancies among us, please. We'll not tolerate babes in the woods, small children who are an easy mark for impostors.
- 14 Then we will no longer be infants, tossed back and forth by the waves, and blown here and there by every wind of teaching and by the cunning and craftiness of men in their deceitful scheming.
- 15 God wants us to grow up, to know the whole truth and tell it in love--like Christ in everything. We take our lead from Christ, who is the source of everything we do.
- 15 Instead, speaking the truth in love, we will in all things grow up into him who is the Head, that is, Christ.
- 16 He keeps us in step with each other. His very breath and blood flow through us, nourishing us so that we will grow up healthy in God, robust in love.

- 16 From him the whole body, joined and held together by every supporting ligament, grows and builds itself up in love, as each part does its work.
- 17 And so I insist--and God backs me up on this--that there be no going along with the crowd, the empty-headed, mindless crowd.
- 17 So I tell you this, and insist on it in the Lord, that you must no longer live as the Gentiles do, in the futility of their thinking.
- 18 They've refused for so long to deal with God that they've lost touch not only with God but with reality itself.
- 18 They are darkened in their understanding and separated from the life of God because of the ignorance that is in them due to the hardening of their hearts.
- 19 They can't think straight anymore. Feeling no pain, they let themselves go in sexual obsession, addicted to every sort of perversion.
- 19 Having lost all sensitivity, they have given themselves over to sensuality so as to indulge in every kind of impurity, with a continual lust for more.
- 20 But that's no life for you. You learned Christ!
- 20 You, however, did not come to know Christ that way.
- 21 My assumption is that you have paid careful attention to him, been well instructed in the truth precisely as we have it in Jesus.
- 21 Surely you heard of him and were taught in him in accordance with the truth that is in Jesus.
- 22 Since, then, we do not have the excuse of ignorance, everything--and I do mean everything--connected with that old way of life has to go. It's rotten through and through. Get rid of it! And then take on an entirely new way of life--a God-fashioned life,
- 22 You were taught, with regard to your former way of life, to put off your old self, which is being corrupted by its deceitful desires;
- 23 a life renewed from the inside
- 23 to be made new in the attitude of your minds;
- 24 and working itself into your conduct as God accurately reproduces his character in you.
- 24 and to put on the new self, created to be like God in true righteousness and holiness.
- 25 What this adds up to, then, is this: no more lies, no more pretense. Tell your neighbor the truth. In Christ's body we're all connected to each other, after all. When you lie to others, you end up lying to yourself.

- 25 Therefore each of you must put off falsehood and speak truthfully to his neighbor, for we are all members of one body.
- 26 Go ahead and be angry. You do well to be angry--but don't use your anger as fuel for revenge. And don't stay angry. Don't go to bed angry.
- 26 In your anger do not sin : Do not let the sun go down while you are still angry,
- 27 Don't give the Devil that kind of foothold in your life.
- 27 and do not give the devil a foothold.
- 28 Did you used to make ends meet by stealing? Well, no more! Get an honest job so that you can help others who can't work.
- 28 He who has been stealing must steal no longer, but must work, doing something useful with his own hands, that he may have something to share with those in need.
- 29 Watch the way you talk. Let nothing foul or dirty come out of your mouth. Say only what helps, each word a gift.
- 29 Do not let any unwholesome talk come out of your mouths, but only what is helpful for building others up according to their needs, that it may benefit those who listen.
- 30 Don't grieve God. Don't break his heart. His Holy Spirit, moving and breathing in you, is the most intimate part of your life, making you fit for himself. Don't take such a gift for granted.
- 30 And do not grieve the Holy Spirit of God, with whom you were sealed for the day of redemption.
- 31 Make a clean break with all cutting, backbiting, profane talk.
- 31 Get rid of all bitterness, rage and anger, brawling and slander, along with every form of malice.
- 32 Be gentle with one another, sensitive. Forgive one another as quickly and thoroughly as God in Christ forgave you.
- 32 Be kind and compassionate to one another, forgiving each other, just as in Christ God forgave you.

Ephesians 5

MSG

NIV

- 1 Watch what God does, and then you do it, like children who learn proper behavior from their parents.
- 1 Be imitators of God, therefore, as dearly loved children
- 2 Mostly what God does is love you. Keep company with him and learn a life of love. Observe how Christ loved us. His love was not cautious but extravagant. He didn't love in order to get something from us but to give everything of himself to us. Love like that.
- 2 and live a life of love, just as Christ loved us and gave himself up for us as a fragrant offering and sacrifice to God.
- 3 Don't allow love to turn into lust, setting off a downhill slide into sexual promiscuity, filthy practices, or bullying greed.
- 3 But among you there must not be even a hint of sexual immorality, or of any kind of impurity, or of greed, because these are improper for God's holy people.
- 4 Though some tongues just love the taste of gossip, Christians have better uses for language than that. Don't talk dirty or silly. That kind of talk doesn't fit our style. Thanksgiving is our dialect.
- 4 Nor should there be obscenity, foolish talk or coarse joking, which are out of place, but rather thanksgiving.
- 5 You can be sure that using people or religion or things just for what you can get out of them--the usual variations on idolatry--will get you nowhere, and certainly nowhere near the kingdom of Christ, the kingdom of God.
- 5 For of this you can be sure: No immoral, impure or greedy person--such a man is an idolater--has any inheritance in the kingdom of Christ and of God.
- 6 Don't let yourselves get taken in by religious smooth talk. God gets furious with people who are full of religious sales talk but want nothing to do with him.
- 6 Let no one deceive you with empty words, for because of such things God's wrath comes on those who are disobedient.
- 7 Don't even hang around people like that.
- 7 Therefore do not be partners with them.
- 8 You groped your way through that murk once, but no longer. You're out in the open now. The bright light of Christ makes your way plain. So no more stumbling around. Get on with it!

- 8 For you were once darkness, but now you are light in the Lord. Live as children of light
- 9 The good, the right, the true--these are the actions appropriate for daylight hours.
- 9 (for the fruit of the light consists in all goodness, righteousness and truth)
- 10 Figure out what will please Christ, and then do it.
- 10 and find out what pleases the Lord.
- 11 Don't waste your time on useless work, mere busywork, the barren pursuits of darkness. Expose these things for the sham they are.
- 11 Have nothing to do with the fruitless deeds of darkness, but rather expose them.
- 12 It's a scandal when people waste their lives on things they must do in the darkness where no one will see.
- 12 For it is shameful even to mention what the disobedient do in secret.
- 13 Rip the cover off those frauds and see how attractive they look in the light of Christ.
- 13 But everything exposed by the light becomes visible,
- 14 Wake up from your sleep, Climb out of your coffins; Christ will show you the light!
- 14 for it is light that makes everything visible. This is why it is said: "Wake up, O sleeper, rise from the dead, and Christ will shine on you."
- 15 So watch your step. Use your head.
- 15 Be very careful, then, how you live--not as unwise but as wise,
- 16 Make the most of every chance you get. These are desperate times!
- 16 making the most of every opportunity, because the days are evil.
- 17 Don't live carelessly, unthinkingly. Make sure you understand what the Master wants.
- 17 Therefore do not be foolish, but understand what the Lord's will is.
- 18 Don't drink too much wine. That cheapens your life. Drink the Spirit of God, huge draughts of him.
- 18 Do not get drunk on wine, which leads to debauchery. Instead, be filled with the Spirit.
- 19 Sing hymns instead of drinking songs! Sing songs from your heart to Christ.
- 19 Speak to one another with psalms, hymns and spiritual songs. Sing and make music in your heart to the Lord,

- 20 Sing praises over everything, any excuse for a song to God the Father in the name of our Master, Jesus Christ.
- 20 always giving thanks to God the Father for everything, in the name of our Lord Jesus Christ.
- 21 Out of respect for Christ, be courteously reverent to one another.
- 21 Submit to one another out of reverence for Christ.
- 22 Wives, understand and support your husbands in ways that show your support for Christ.
- 22 Wives, submit to your husbands as to the Lord.
- 23 The husband provides leadership to his wife the way Christ does to his church, not by domineering but by cherishing.
- 23 For the husband is the head of the wife as Christ is the head of the church, his body, of which he is the Savior.
- 24 So just as the church submits to Christ as he exercises such leadership, wives should likewise submit to their husbands.
- 24 Now as the church submits to Christ, so also wives should submit to their husbands in everything.
- 25 Husbands, go all out in your love for your wives, exactly as Christ did for the church--a love marked by giving, not getting.
- 25 Husbands, love your wives, just as Christ loved the church and gave himself up for her
- 26 Christ's love makes the church whole. His words evoke her beauty. Everything he does and says is designed to bring the best out of her,
- 26 to make her holy, cleansing her by the washing with water through the word,
- 27 dressing her in dazzling white silk, radiant with holiness.
- 27 and to present her to himself as a radiant church, without stain or wrinkle or any other blemish, but holy and blameless.
- 28 And that is how husbands ought to love their wives. They're really doing themselves a favor--since they're already "one" in marriage.
- 28 In this same way, husbands ought to love their wives as their own bodies. He who loves his wife loves himself.
- 29 No one abuses his own body, does he? No, he feeds and pampers it. That's how Christ treats us, the church,
- 29 After all, no one ever hated his own body, but he feeds and cares for it, just as Christ does the church--

- 30 since we are part of his body.
30 for we are members of his body.
31 And this is why a man leaves father and mother and cherishes his wife.
No longer two, they become "one flesh."
31 For this reason a man will leave his father and mother and be united to
his wife, and the two will become one flesh.
32 This is a huge mystery, and I don't pretend to understand it all. What is
clearest to me is the way Christ treats the church.
32 This is a profound mystery--but I am talking about Christ and the
church.
33 And this provides a good picture of how each husband is to treat his
wife, loving himself in loving her, and how each wife is to honor her
husband.
33 However, each one of you also must love his wife as he loves himself,
and the wife must respect her husband.

Ephesians 6

MSG

NIV

- 1 Children, do what your parents tell you. This is only right.
1 Children, obey your parents in the Lord, for this is right.
2 "Honor your father and mother" is the first commandment that has a
promise attached to it, namely,
2 Honor your father and mother--which is the first commandment with a
promise--
3 "so you will live well and have a long life."
3 that it may go well with you and that you may enjoy long life on the
earth.
4 Fathers, don't exasperate your children by coming down hard on them.
Take them by the hand and lead them in the way of the Master.
4 Fathers, do not exasperate your children; instead, bring them up in the
training and instruction of the Lord.
5 Servants, respectfully obey your earthly masters but always with an eye
to obeying the real master, Christ.

- 5 Slaves, obey your earthly masters with respect and fear, and with sincerity of heart, just as you would obey Christ.
- 6 Don't just do what you have to do to get by, but work heartily, as Christ's servants doing what God wants you to do.
- 6 Obey them not only to win their favor when their eye is on you, but like slaves of Christ, doing the will of God from your heart.
- 7 And work with a smile on your face, always keeping in mind that no matter who happens to be giving the orders, you're really serving God.
- 7 Serve wholeheartedly, as if you were serving the Lord, not men,
- 8 Good work will get you good pay from the Master, regardless of whether you are slave or free.
- 8 because you know that the Lord will reward everyone for whatever good he does, whether he is slave or free.
- 9 Masters, it's the same with you. No abuse, please, and no threats. You and your servants are both under the same Master in heaven. He makes no distinction between you and them.
- 9 And masters, treat your slaves in the same way. Do not threaten them, since you know that he who is both their Master and yours is in heaven, and there is no favoritism with him.
- 10 And that about wraps it up. God is strong, and he wants you strong.
- 10 Finally, be strong in the Lord and in his mighty power.
- 11 So take everything the Master has set out for you, well-made weapons of the best materials. And put them to use so you will be able to stand up to everything the Devil throws your way.
- 11 Put on the full armor of God so that you can take your stand against the devil's schemes.
- 12 This is no afternoon athletic contest that we'll walk away from and forget about in a couple of hours. This is for keeps, a life-or-death fight to the finish against the Devil and all his angels.
- 12 For our struggle is not against flesh and blood, but against the rulers, against the authorities, against the powers of this dark world and against the spiritual forces of evil in the heavenly realms.
- 13 Be prepared. You're up against far more than you can handle on your own. Take all the help you can get, every weapon God has issued, so that when it's all over but the shouting you'll still be on your feet.

- 13 Therefore put on the full armor of God, so that when the day of evil comes, you may be able to stand your ground, and after you have done everything, to stand.
- 14 Truth, righteousness,
- 14 Stand firm then, with the belt of truth buckled around your waist, with the breastplate of righteousness in place,
- 15 peace,
- 15 and with your feet fitted with the readiness that comes from the gospel of peace.
- 16 faith,
- 16 In addition to all this, take up the shield of faith, with which you can extinguish all the flaming arrows of the evil one.
- 17 and salvation are more than words. Learn how to apply them. You'll need them throughout your life. God's Word is an indispensable weapon.
- 17 Take the helmet of salvation and the sword of the Spirit, which is the word of God.
- 18 In the same way, prayer is essential in this ongoing warfare. Pray hard and long. Pray for your brothers and sisters. Keep your eyes open. Keep each other's spirits up so that no one falls behind or drops out.
- 18 And pray in the Spirit on all occasions with all kinds of prayers and requests. With this in mind, be alert and always keep on praying for all the saints.
- 19 And don't forget to pray for me. Pray that I'll know what to say and have the courage to say it at the right time, telling the mystery to one and all, the Message that I,
- 19 Pray also for me, that whenever I open my mouth, words may be given me so that I will fearlessly make known the mystery of the gospel,
- 20 jailbird preacher that I am, am responsible for getting out.
- 20 for which I am an ambassador in chains. Pray that I may declare it fearlessly, as I should.
- 21 Tychicus, my good friend here, will tell you what I'm doing and how things are going with me. He is certainly a dependable servant of the Master!
- 21 Tychicus, the dear brother and faithful servant in the Lord, will tell you everything, so that you also may know how I am and what I am doing.

22 I've sent him not only to tell you about us but to cheer you on in your faith.

22 I am sending him to you for this very purpose, that you may know how we are, and that he may encourage you.

23 Good-bye, friends. Love mixed with faith be yours from God the Father and from the Master, Jesus Christ.

23 Peace to the brothers, and love with faith from God the Father and the Lord Jesus Christ.

24 Pure grace and nothing but grace be with all who love our Master, Jesus Christ.

24 Grace to all who love our Lord Jesus Christ with an undying love.